

■ 3-MONTH BACKEND DEVELOPER ROADMAP

Node.js → Express → Auth → MongoDB · Week-by-Week · Build Every Week

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3	12	4 hrs	1
Months	Weeks	Daily	Project/Week

■ DAILY PLAN (4 hours/day)

1.5 hr	1.5 hr	1 hr
■ Learning	■ Coding	■ Project

■■ TOOLS YOU MUST KNOW

■ Postman	Test all your APIs before connecting to frontend — use it from day one
■■ Git & GitHub	Daily commits, push every project, version control your backend code
■ MongoDB Atlas	Cloud MongoDB — free tier, connect from anywhere, no local setup needed

■ RULES — FOLLOW THIS

■	Don't just watch tutorials — open Postman and build something
■	Don't copy-paste code — type every line yourself and understand it
■	Build APIs yourself — notes, users, tasks CRUD — all from scratch
■	Do at least one project every week — push it to GitHub daily

■ MONTH 1 — Node.js + Core Backend Basics

Month 1	Node.js + Core Backend Basics
Week 1	■ What is Backend — server, client-server architecture, how web works ■ HTTP / HTTPS — methods (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE), status codes ■ APIs — what they are, why we need them, JSON format, REST vs SOAP ■ How a request travels — DNS, server, response cycle ■ <i>...and more</i>
Week 2	■ What is Node.js — event loop, non-blocking I/O, why it's fast ■ Modules — require/import, CommonJS vs ES Modules ■ Built-in modules — fs (file system), path, os, http ■ npm — package.json, installing packages, node_modules, scripts ■ <i>...and more</i>
Week 3	■ Express.js — why Express, installing, creating a server ■ Routing — app.get(), app.post(), app.put(), app.delete() ■ Request & Response — req.body, req.params, req.query, res.json() ■ Middleware concept intro — app.use(), express.json() ■ <i>...and more</i>
Week 4	■ REST API design — resource-based URLs, proper HTTP methods ■ CRUD operations — Create, Read, Update, Delete endpoints ■ Postman — sending requests, setting headers, body, testing endpoints ■ In-memory data — use arrays before connecting to real DB ■ <i>...and more</i>
■ BUILD	■ Users CRUD API ■ Notes CRUD API <i>...etc.</i>
■ GOAL	<i>You should be able to create and test REST APIs using Postman</i>

■ MONTH 2 — Advanced Backend + Authentication

Month 2	Advanced Backend + Authentication
Week 1	■ Middleware — what it is, how it sits between request and response ■ Custom middleware — logging, request time, validation middleware ■ Third-party middleware — morgan (logging), express.json(), cors ■ Middleware chaining — next() function, order matters ■ ...and more
Week 2	■ try-catch — wrapping async route handlers, catching errors ■ Global error handler — centralised error middleware (4 params) ■ HTTP error responses — proper status codes (400, 401, 403, 404, 500) ■ Async wrapper — asyncHandler utility to avoid repetition ■ ...and more
Week 3	■ JWT (JSON Web Token) — what it is, header.payload.signature structure ■ Login flow — user logs in → server signs JWT → client stores it ■ jwt.sign() and jwt.verify() — creating and verifying tokens ■ bcrypt — why plain passwords are dangerous, hashing + salting ■ ...and more
Week 4	■ Role-based access control — admin vs user roles in JWT payload ■ Protected routes — auth middleware that checks JWT on every request ■ Authorization vs Authentication — who you are vs what you can do ■ Refresh tokens — access token expiry, refresh token flow (optional) ■ ...and more
■ BUILD	■ Signup API ■ Login API ■ Protected Routes ...etc.
■ GOAL	You should be able to build secure backend systems with auth

■ MONTH 3 — Database + Full Backend Project

Month 3	Database + Full Backend Project
Week 1	■ Database basics — SQL vs NoSQL, when to use which ■ MongoDB — documents, collections, Atlas cloud setup, Compass GUI ■ CRUD in MongoDB — insertOne, find, updateOne, deleteOne, filters ■ ...and more
Week 2	■ Mongoose — ODM for MongoDB, connecting Node.js to Atlas ■ Schemas — defining fields, types (String, Number, Date, Boolean) ■ Models — creating, saving, querying, updating; populate() for relations ■ ...and more
Week 3	■ Connect backend + database — replace in-memory arrays with DB calls ■ Full CRUD API with MongoDB — all routes hitting real database ■ Environment variables — dotenv, .env file, never commit secrets ■ ...and more
Week 4	■ Final project week — combine Auth + CRUD + DB in one full app ■ MVC structure — models/, controllers/, routes/ folder separation ■ Deploy backend — Render.com free tier, set env vars, test in Postman ■ ...and more
■ BUILD	■ Blog API (auth + CRUD + DB) ■ Task Manager API ...etc.

■ END-OF-ROADMAP PROJECT CHECKLIST

Project	Must Include
■ Users CRUD API	GET, POST, PUT, DELETE — tested fully in Postman
■ Notes CRUD API	In-memory storage, proper REST endpoints, status codes
■ Auth System	Signup, Login, bcrypt hashing, JWT tokens, protected routes
■ DB-connected API	MongoDB Atlas + Mongoose, full CRUD hitting real database
■ Full Backend App	Auth + DB + CRUD + MVC + deployed on Render

■ RESOURCES — Everything You Need to Become a Backend Dev

Type	Name	Link	What for
■ DOCS	MDN Web Docs	developer.mozilla.org/en-US/	Best reference for JS & HTTP — use every day
■ DOCS	W3Schools	w3schools.com	Quick reference for Node.js, SQL, JSON basics
■ OUR SITE	Syntax Error	syntaxerrorr.com	Notes, one-shot videos, DSA + web dev resources
■ YOUTUBE	Web Dev Simplified	youtube.com/@WebDevSimplified	Node.js, Express, JWT, MongoDB — all 3 months
■ YOUTUBE	freeCodeCamp	youtube.com/@freecodecamp	Full-length free courses on every backend tech

■■ YOUTUBE	Code With Harry	youtube.com/@CodeWithHarry	Hindi Node.js + backend series — very structured
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SYNTAX ERROR	Our Website syntaxerrorr.com	Our Instagram @code.abhii07
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*"APIs don't build themselves. Close YouTube, open Postman, and make your first endpoint respond.
That's how backend devs are born. ■■"*